John McDermott

- Rigour, Relevance and Relationships by Dr John McDermott, Executive Director, Motu Economic and Public Policy Research
- Studied Commerce at the University of Auckland
- RBNZ as an economist
- PhD Economics
- Economist at IMF
- RBNZ and National Bank
- Associate Professor here
- Assistant governor of the RBNZ
- Executive director of Motu

- **Inflation, expectations and monetary policy.** John has studied how inflation targeting in New Zealand has evolved, what happened to inflation expectations when the target changed, and why inflation stayed low after the GFC. He has also examined how the business cycle and monetary policy changed after the crisis. **As inflation and central bank credibility are back in the headlines, this work is very timely.**
- **Business cycles, commodity prices and open economies.** From his years at the IMF and the RBNZ, John has written widely cited work on booms and slumps in world commodity prices, terms-of-trade shocks, real exchange rates and macroeconomic swings in developing countries. He has also built New Zealand's long-run quarterly GDP series and asked whether New Zealand should share a currency with Australia.